BENCHMARK® INTERNATIONAL

QUARTERLY INDUSTRY REPORT | Q4 2026

INDUSTRIALS

Order books are full and financing costs more. Buyers are paying the most for what they cannot build in time: power and data center work, certified aerospace machining, and the service revenue that codes and regulations require.

- Manufacturing & Industrial Technology
- Industrial Distribution & Services
- Building Products & Construction Services
- Energy, Power & Environmental Services
- Transportation & Logistics

WHAT'S INCLUDED

01 **Insights**
Sector perspectives, the power demand buildout, our view, and a featured engagement

02 **Sector Activity**
Transactions, public company metrics, earnings commentary, economic trends, and market participants

03 **About Benchmark**
Benchmark and the Middle Market team

October 2026 | Jared Hardin, Managing Director

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Our Team

The Middle Market team leads each engagement from the first conversation through signing and closing.

Middle Market

The Middle Market team represents owners of privately held companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value in strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions.

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INDUSTRIALS COVERAGE

- Manufacturing & Industrial Tech
- Distribution & Services
- Building & Construction
- Energy, Power & Environmental
- Transportation & Logistics

Benchmark International Middle Market team as of October 2026.

01 Insights

American manufacturing has expanded for nine consecutive months. Acquirers across the industrial sectors are buying capabilities they cannot build in time, because skilled labor is scarce, certifications take years, and new equipment is sold out well ahead. Borrowing costs rose in September, and buyers have become more selective about what they pay for.

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Market Insights: Q4 2026

Demand spans the five sectors, and buyers are acquiring through existing platforms. Higher financing costs in September reduced sponsors' borrowing capacity.



WHAT IT MEANS FOR OWNERS

Strategic acquirers and sponsor platforms are still buying machining, distribution, contracting, environmental, and logistics businesses for capabilities already in place.

They are paying the most for companies tied to power, data centers, aerospace, and service work that codes and regulations require.

Domestic manufacturing demand is broad

The ISM Manufacturing PMI was 54.5 in September, its ninth consecutive month of expansion, and orders for manufacturing technology reached $4.03 billion in the first seven months of the year, 37.1% ahead of 2025 (ISM; AMT data reported by MDM). Manufacturing capacity utilization was 75.9% in September, so the scarce inputs are skilled labor and certified capacity rather than floor space (Federal Reserve G.17).

54.5

ISM Manufacturing PMI, September

Private equity is buying through platforms it already owns

Add-on acquisitions made up about three-quarters of all buyouts in the second quarter (PitchBook), and Pye-Barker Fire & Safety completed 22 acquisitions in the first half of the year alone (Pye-Barker). The sponsor at the table for a founder-owned industrial company is usually an operating platform that already knows its trade.

13,509

US companies held by private equity, Q2 2026 (PitchBook)

Power and data center work is the strongest source of demand

Quanta Services ended June with backlog of $53.4 billion against $35.8 billion a year earlier (Quanta Services). Public infrastructure funding is less certain, because the surface transportation authorization was extended only through December 11 under the continuing resolution signed in September (AASHTO Journal).

$53.4B

Quanta Services total backlog June 2026

Recurring service revenue is valued above project revenue

APi Group is working toward 60% of revenue from inspection and service, and Transcat's service revenue grew 27% (APi Group; Transcat). Buyers pay for service, repair, inspection, and aftermarket parts revenue when an owner reports it separately from project and product sales, with the renewal history behind it.

60%

APi Group target for inspection and service revenue

Financing costs more and buyers are more selective

Global M&A value fell 41% from the second quarter to $993 billion in the third, and the Federal Reserve raised its target range to 3.75% to 4.00% on September 16 (LSEG data reported by Reuters; Federal Reserve). GF Data's average multiple eased to 7.0 times trailing adjusted EBITDA from 7.3 times, and debt on platform acquisitions fell to 2.9 times from 3.4 times (GF Data via ACG). A sponsor that can borrow half a turn less bids less or moves more of the price into earn-outs; strategic buyers are affected less.

7.0x

Average middle-market multiple of EBITDA, Q2

Figures are as reported by the linked sources. Middle-market multiple and debt figures are GF Data sponsor-reported averages for the first and second quarters of 2026.

Perspectives on Five Sectors

The five sectors draw different buyers and respond to different drivers.

MANUFACTURING & INDUSTRIAL TECH

The sector earns the highest EBITDA margin of the five at 22.1% and trades at the highest multiple at 17.3x.

ACTIVE BUYERS

nVent, Franklin Electric, Precinmac (Centerbridge Partners), DXP Enterprises, Cemtrex, and Assessimus Group.

LISTED REFERENCE COMPANIES

Parker, Rockwell Automation, ITT, Flowserve, Franklin Electric, Graco, Lincoln Electric, Mueller Industries

INDUSTRIAL DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

Distributors now trade at 17.0x EBITDA against 13.1x at year-end 2025, and shares of the eight listed distributors rose over the year.

ACTIVE BUYERS

Ferguson, Meritus Gas Partners (AEA Investors), Cintas, TIPCO Technologies, and Aecon Group.

LISTED REFERENCE COMPANIES

Fastenal, Grainger, Applied Industrial Technologies, MSC, DXP, DSG Distribution Solutions Group, Wesco, Global Industrial

BUILDING PRODUCTS & CONSTRUCTION

Listed contractors grew revenue 21.8% and EBITDA 28%, and Benchmark closed 45 transactions here, the most among the five sectors.

ACTIVE BUYERS

Limbach, Bay Crane, Harris Company, Phenna Group, and Capital Extension Crane & Lift.

LISTED REFERENCE COMPANIES

Comfort Systems USA, EMCOR, IES, Limbach, Granite, Construction Partners Inc., Builders FirstSource, Watsco

Also: APi Group.

ENERGY, POWER & ENVIRONMENTAL

The sector carries the heaviest leverage at 2.5x net debt to EBITDA and the lowest free cash flow conversion at 44.7%, while EBITDA grew 21.2%.

ACTIVE BUYERS

Clean Harbors, Mission Critical Group (Emerald Lake Capital Management), Triumvirate Environmental, and Apex Water and Process.

LISTED REFERENCE COMPANIES

Generac, Quanta, Clean Harbors, Republic Services, Waste Connections, Casella, MYR Group, Primoris

TRANSPORTATION & LOGISTICS

Shares rose 38.9% over the year and the sector still trades at the lowest multiple of the five at 12.2x, with EBITDA down 0.8%.

ACTIVE BUYERS

C.H. Robinson, Redwood Logistics (AEA Investors), Imperative Logistics, and Symbia Logistics.

LISTED REFERENCE COMPANIES

J.B. Hunt, Werner, C.H. Robinson, Landstar, Schneider, ArcBest

Also: Knight-Swift.

SECTOR SCORECARD

Listed company metrics from pages 16 to 18, with Benchmark International closed transactions by sector.

	EV / EBITDA	Rev. growth	EBITDA mgn.	Deals
Manufacturing & Industrial Tech	17.3x	8.8%	22.1%	22
Distribution & Services	17.0x	8.6%	11.2%	8
Building & Construction	15.8x	21.8%	10.7%	45
Energy, Power & Environmental	16.3x	5.4%	16.8%	7
Transportation & Logistics	12.2x	4.1%	10.1%	3

Closed deals are counts of Benchmark transactions.

Active buyers are drawn from the transactions on pages 13 to 15 and the sources on pages 5 and 7. Company names and logos are the property of their owners and are shown for identification.

Power Demand: How the Buildout Reaches the Industrial Sectors

Electricity demand grows about 2% a year and the equipment is sold out years ahead, so acquirers buy the people, permits, and delivery slots already in place.

The Energy Information Administration expects US electricity sales to grow about 2% in 2026 and again in 2027, driven by data center development and commercial and industrial activity (EIA). NERC raised its 10-year forecast of summer peak demand growth to 224 gigawatts from 132 (POWER Magazine), and Meta alone expects capital expenditures of $130 billion to $145 billion in 2026 (Meta).

The equipment needed to meet that demand is committed years ahead. GE Vernova's gas turbine backlog and slot reservations rose to 116 gigawatts from 100 during the second quarter (GE Vernova), and lead times for generator step-up transformers reached 160 weeks in the first quarter (Reuters, citing Wood Mackenzie). Generac's commercial and industrial sales grew 29% and its data center backlog reached about $1.6 billion (Generac).

Power is the constraint

"So, it's interesting as they continue to announce all the data centers and data center sites. I've sort of always had the strong view that energy would be the constraint."
Greg Abel, CEO, Berkshire Hathaway (CNBC)

"Well, I don't think it's going to come down to chips or the models that people create or the apps that we develop. I think the consistent theme you hear here is can we get the power generation to power these massive data centers."
Toby Rice, CEO, EQT (EQT Corporation)

"Quite frankly, the biggest issue we are now having is not a compute glut, but it's a power and it's sort of the ability to get the builds done fast enough close to power. So, if you can't do that, you may actually have a bunch of chips sitting in inventory that I can't plug in."
Satya Nadella, CEO, Microsoft (Bg2 Pod)

HOW THE DEMAND REACHES EACH SECTOR

MANUFACTURING & INDUSTRIAL TECHNOLOGY

nVent agreed to buy Maverick Power, a Texas maker of switchgear and modular power for data centers, for $1.75 billion plus up to $550 million, which it put at 11.5 times anticipated 2026 adjusted EBITDA on the upfront payment (nVent).

INDUSTRIAL DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

EMCOR's US Industrial Services segment grew 25.9% in the second quarter (EMCOR). The segment serves refining, petrochemical, utility, and power customers, where turnaround and maintenance work recurs on a schedule that an acquirer can underwrite.

BUILDING PRODUCTS & CONSTRUCTION SERVICES

Contractors doing data center work reported 9.9 months of backlog against 8.3 months for those that are not (ABC). Limbach lowered its margin guidance after gross margin fell to 21.5% from 28.0%, mainly on the lower margins of an acquired business, with competition for skilled labor and materials in data center markets as a second factor (Limbach).

ENERGY, POWER & ENVIRONMENTAL SERVICES

Mission Critical Group bought a Texas switchgear manufacturer and a transformer supplier within four months of each other (Dallas Innovates; Distribution Strategy Group). CORE keeps more than 1,000 transformers in inventory and delivers custom units in as little as 16 weeks, against lead times measured in years for new production.

TRANSPORTATION & LOGISTICS

Data center construction spending is up more than 73% over the past year (ABC, reported by Construction Dive), and the transformers, switchgear, and generators behind it move by heavy haul and project freight. JK Technology Services bought 360 Rigging, a Manassas, Virginia crane and rigging company that installs equipment in data centers (Vertikal).



THE BUILDOUT IN FOUR FIGURES

224 GW
NERC 10-year forecast of summer peak demand growth, raised from 132

116 GW
GE Vernova gas turbine backlog and slot reservations

160 weeks
Lead time for generator step-up transformers

9.9 months
Backlog at contractors doing data center work

A buyer will ask how much of the backlog is tied to funded power and data center work, and whether the company has the technicians to perform it at the margins it has earned so far.

Transaction values and multiples are as stated by the acquirer in the linked announcement. Backlog figures are from company second-quarter reports and the ABC member survey for August 2026. Capacity and lead-time figures are as reported by the named company or outlet.

What We're Reading

Four pieces from the quarter that shape how buyers and owners are talking.

FROM THE QUARTER

Reading list

The four pieces cover manufacturing orders, grid equipment supply, middle-market financing terms, and cross-border freight volume, which are separate inputs to a sale process.

The takeaways under the quotes tie the reading to what owners should have prepared before they go to market.

ISM | 1 OCTOBER 2026

Manufacturing PMI® at 54.5%; September 2026 ISM® Manufacturing PMI® Report

> *"The New Orders Index expanded for the ninth consecutive month after four straight readings in contraction."*
> Susan Spence, Chair, ISM Manufacturing Business Survey Committee

The September PMI reached 54.5%, and new orders have grown nine months running after four months of contraction, so an owner planning a sale should show two or three quarters of order growth in the monthly financials before going to market.

READ HERE

REUTERS (VIA KITCO NEWS) | 9 JULY 2026

US power companies scramble to secure equipment as surging data center demand strains supplies

> *"Equipment availability is becoming the biggest concern for developers as they value time to market so highly."*
> Ben Boucher, senior analyst, Wood Mackenzie

Generator step-up transformer lead times passed 160 weeks against 143 weeks on average in 2024, and utilities now buy equipment for projects they expect five years ahead, so owners serving grid and data center work should document backlog, supplier agreements, and delivery slots before launching a process.

READ HERE

ACG (GF DATA) | 27 AUGUST 2026

GF Data Reports Show Steady Middle-Market Deal Flow Amid More Selective Financing Conditions in Q2

> *"Average total debt on platform transactions declined to 2.9x TTM EBITDA from 3.4x in Q1."*
> GF Data Leverage Report

Average purchase multiples slipped to 7.0x from 7.3x across 85 completed deals in the second quarter while senior debt pricing rose to 7.8%, so sellers should expect price discipline and use a quality of earnings report to defend a premium.

READ HERE

FREIGHTWAVES | 7 OCTOBER 2026

Mexico remains top US trading partner as August commerce hits $94.3B

> *"Imports through Laredo totaled $26.23 billion, a 33.9% increase, while exports increased 18.3% to $12.34 billion."*
> Noi Mahoney, FreightWaves (reporting Census trade data)

August trade between the US and Mexico reached $94.3 billion and Laredo two-way trade rose 28.5%, so owners with cross-border exposure should document customer mix, tariff pass-through terms, and lane concentration, which buyers test in diligence.

READ HERE

Quotations are taken from the linked publications. Headlines and quotations remain the property of their publishers.

Our View

Five conclusions from the quarter, and what they mean for an owner planning a sale in 2027.

OUR VIEW IN ONE LINE

Buyers are paying premiums for specialized capabilities. Higher borrowing costs affect the offers they can make.

FOR AN OWNER GOING TO MARKET IN 2027

Report service, inspection, and aftermarket revenue separately from project and product sales, with renewal history.

Show backlog by end market and funded status, and name the technicians who will perform it.

Document how steel, diesel, and transformer cost increases pass through each contract.

01

Specialized capabilities command higher prices

nVent paid 11.5 times for switchgear it could not build in time, Clean Harbors about 17 times standalone EBITDA for a route network, and Redwood and Imperative bought Laredo brokers for licenses and bonded space. A founder-owned company that holds a certification, a permit, a delivery slot, or a license that takes years to replicate is priced on that asset, at 8 to 12 times, against about 6 times for project and product capacity.

02

Higher rates affect sponsor financing

With the funds rate at 3.75% to 4.00%, the 10-year near 5%, and sponsor leverage at 2.9 times, a platform bid carries half a turn less debt than it did in the spring. Strategic acquirers with cash and synergies are affected less, and we expect their share of mid-market industrial sales, 56% of our closed transactions over two years, to rise through 2027. Sponsor offers will lean on earn-outs and seller notes, and the structure deserves as much attention as the headline number.

03

Data center work supports listed contractors' growth

Listed building products and construction companies grew revenue 22% while total construction spending fell 1.7% and manufacturing construction fell 19%. A mid-market contractor with funded data center backlog carries a premium, and one without it competes in a shrinking market for everything else. Limbach's margin reset shows what happens when skilled labor is bid away, so buyers will underwrite the crews along with the backlog.

04

Recurring service revenue supports valuation

APi Group is steering toward 60% inspection and service revenue, Transcat's service line grew 27%, and a project contractor like 1901 Inc. changed hands at 5.7 times. Buyers pay for revenue that renews under codes, regulations, and maintenance schedules, and they will diligence the split. An owner who reports service, repair, inspection, and parts separately, with renewal history, sells a different company from one who reports a single revenue line.

05

Freight recovery and demand for border services

Cass shipments are up 2.1% off a two-year low, transportation shares rose a median 39% in a year, and C.H. Robinson agreed to pay $5.8 billion for RXO with $300 million of synergies behind it. Diesel at $6.29 a gallon is testing surcharge pass-through, and US-Mexico trade at a record $94.8 billion a month is why logistics platforms are buying Laredo brokers. Customs licensing, bonded warehousing, and cross-border capability will be priced above asset-based capacity through 2027.

Views are those of the Benchmark International Middle Market team as of October 19, 2026 and draw on the sources cited on pages 5, 7, and 25. They are opinions, and the price of any company depends on that business.

Our View: Sector Outlook

Demand for owner-operated businesses differs across the five sectors.

OUR VIEW

Buyer demand by sector

Ratings weigh listed-company growth, valuation, and cash conversion against Benchmark closings in the sector, on a scale of one to five.

Energy, Power & Environmental

Transformer lead times above 160 weeks and 21.2% EBITDA growth, offset by 2.5x leverage.



STRONGEST

Building & Construction

EBITDA up 28% on 21.8% revenue growth, and 45 Benchmark closings.



STRONG

Manufacturing & Industrial Tech

The highest margin at 22.1% and the highest multiple at 17.3x.



STRONG

Distribution & Services

17.0x against 13.1x at year-end 2025, with margins near 11%.



STEADY

Transportation & Logistics

Lowest multiple at 12.2x and EBITDA down 0.8%, with shares up 38.9%.



MIXED

THREE STEPS WE ADVISE OWNERS TO TAKE

1. Compare bids on proceeds

Sponsor platform leverage fell to 2.9x EBITDA from 3.4x, so owners should compare offers on cash at close, earn-out, and seller note terms rather than headline multiple alone.

2. Invite strategic buyers

Strategic acquirers account for 56% of the transactions on pages 13 to 15, so a process should include them alongside sponsor platforms.

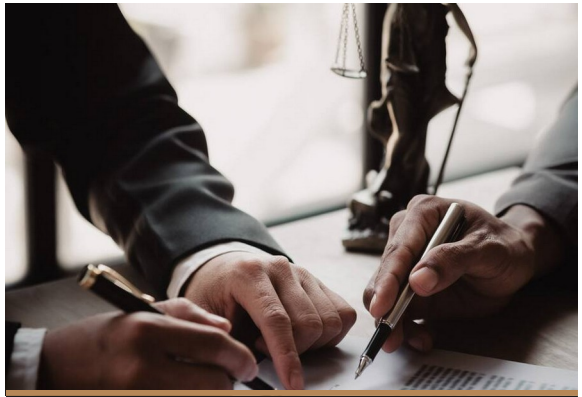
3. Document licenses and delivery slots

Licenses, certifications, permits, and delivery slots belong in the first management presentation, because buyers have paid 8x to 12x for them against about 6x for businesses without them.

Demand ratings are Benchmark International judgments from the metrics on pages 16 to 18 and the sources on pages 5 and 7.

Featured Engagement: The Carmi Companies

A Laredo logistics and customs brokerage group and a Mexico manufacturing services company have combined to form an end-to-end cross-border platform.



BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL ADVISED

CARMI logistics

ON ITS TRANSACTION WITH

THE NEARSHORE COMPANY

Transportation & Logistics
Cross-border freight, customs brokerage, and warehousing

READ THE ANNOUNCEMENT

THE CLIENT

The Carmi Companies

Founded in 1983 in Laredo, Texas, The Carmi Companies is a single-source logistics group that coordinates land, air, and ocean freight and provides customs brokerage, warehousing, and transloading.

THE COUNTERPARTY

The Nearshore Company

Founded in 1992 in Brownsville, Texas, The Nearshore Company offers manufacturing facilities in Mexico together with employer-of-record services.

THE RATIONALE

An end-to-end cross-border platform

The combination pairs The Nearshore Company's Mexico manufacturing facilities and employer-of-record services with Carmi's logistics to form an end-to-end cross-border platform.

THE MARKET

Buyers are paying for border capability

Trade with Mexico reached a monthly record of $94.8 billion in July, 27.5% above a year earlier, and $36.95 billion of it moved through Laredo (Census data reported by FreightWaves). Logistics platforms have responded by buying brokers at the border, and Redwood Logistics and Imperative Logistics Group each acquired a Laredo customs broker this year (FreightWaves on EELCO; FreightWaves on Jose D. Gonzalez, CHB).

> *"The simplest way to describe today's market is that buyers are acquiring capabilities rather than capacity."*
>
> Gaurang Shastri, Managing Director, Lincoln International, speaking to Transport Topics (Lincoln International)

Carmi's brokerage licenses, bonded warehousing, and four decades of Laredo relationships are the capability. The trucks are the capacity, and buyers can rent those.

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02

Sector Activity

Acquirers announced transactions across the five industrial sectors during 2026, with sellers that ranged from founder-owned machine shops and customs brokers to companies bought by public acquirers for several billion dollars. The 40 listed companies tracked on page 16 trade at a median of 16.3 times trailing EBITDA, and the indicators behind demand and financing point in different directions.

13 Select recent industrial transactions

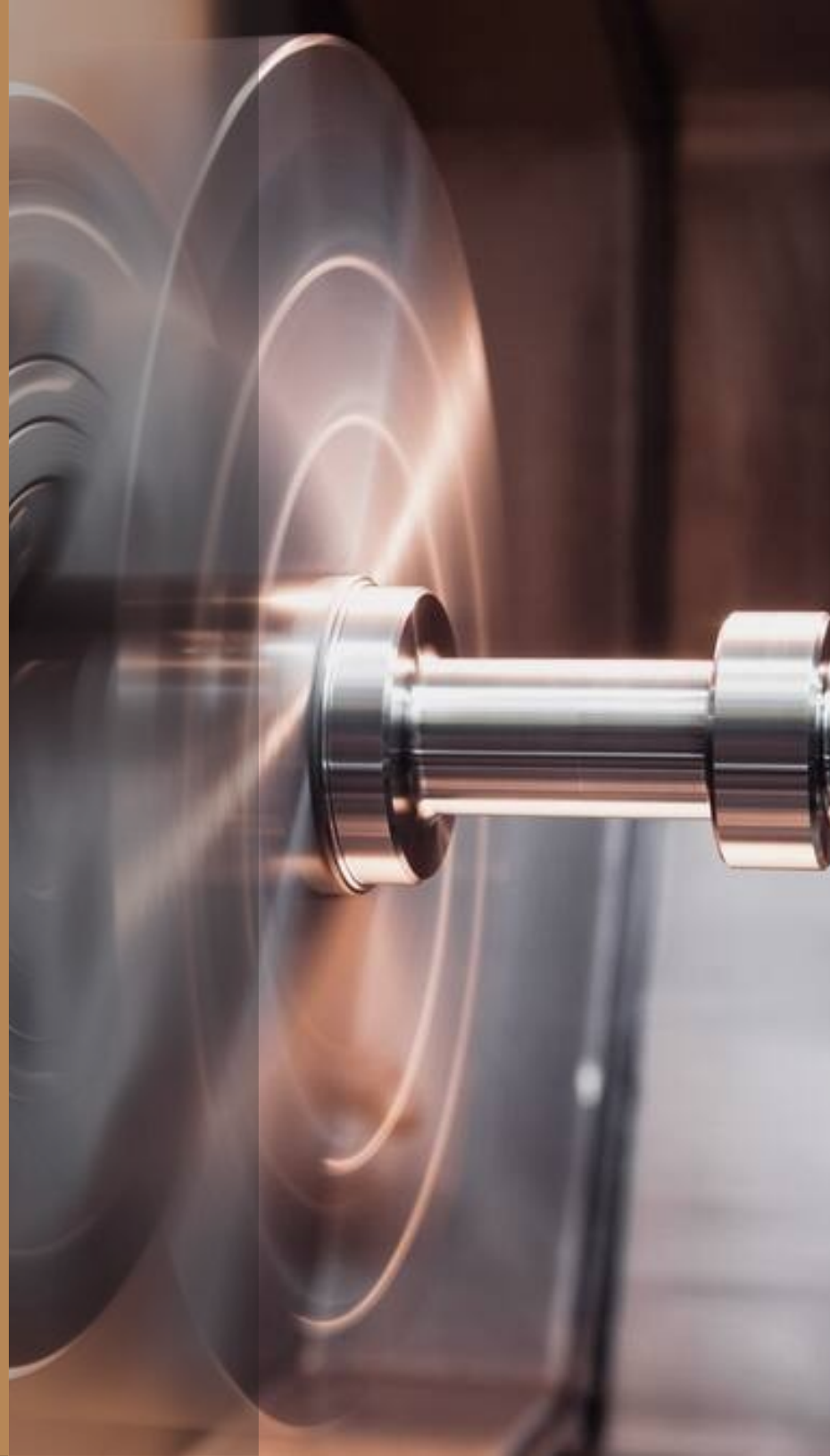
15 Benchmark International's industrial transactions

16 Public company performance and trends

19 Earnings and commentary

20 Economic trends

21 Market participants



Select Recent Industrial Transactions

Public acquirers disclosed prices of about 6 to 10 times EBITDA, and sponsor-owned platforms bought family-owned companies on undisclosed terms.

ANNOUNCED	TARGET AND ACQUIRER	BUSINESS AND TERMS	WHAT IT SHOWS
SEPTEMBER 2026 Manufacturing & Industrial Tech	**CAT PUMPS** *acquired by* **FRANKLIN ELECTRIC**	Franklin Electric acquired Cat Pumps, a Minneapolis maker of high-pressure pumps, for $350 million in cash plus up to $50 million in stock (Franklin Electric).	The upfront payment equals about 7.8 times 2025 adjusted EBITDA of $45 million on $115 million of revenue, a margin near 39%, for a business whose pumps are specified into its customers' equipment.
JULY 2026 Manufacturing & Industrial Tech	**ADVANCE MFG. CO.** *acquired by* **PRECINMAC** Centerbridge Partners	Precinmac acquired Advance Mfg. Co. of Westfield, Massachusetts, family-owned since 1961, which supplies machined components, fabrications, and Nadcap coating for defense and aerospace customers (Precinmac). Terms were not disclosed.	Sponsor-owned platforms are assembling certified aerospace and defense machining capacity, and Precinmac had acquired Precision Aerospace Holdings of Dallas in April.
JULY 2026 Distribution & Services	**FLOWORKS** *acquired by* **FERGUSON**	Ferguson agreed to buy FloWorks, a flow control distributor with about $1 billion of revenue, from Wynnchurch Capital for $1.6 billion and completed the purchase in August (MDM).	Ferguson described the price as about 10 times trailing adjusted EBITDA after including roughly $45 million of expected synergies (MDM).
JULY 2026 Distribution & Services	**METROPLEX WELDING SUPPLY** *acquired by* **MERITUS GAS PARTNERS** AEA Investors	Meritus Gas Partners acquired Metroplex Welding Supply of Dallas, a family-owned distributor of industrial gases and welding supplies founded in 1975 with five locations (MDM). Terms were not disclosed.	Metroplex was Meritus's third announced acquisition of 2026, and most industrial product lines now have a sponsor-backed specialist acquirer of this kind.
SEPTEMBER 2026 Building Products & Construction	**1901 INC.** *acquired by* **LIMBACH HOLDINGS**	Limbach acquired 1901 Inc., a mechanical, electrical, and plumbing contractor in Madison, Wisconsin that it expects to contribute about $140 million of revenue in 2027, for $63 million plus an earn-out of up to $6 million (Pulse 2.0).	The upfront payment is about 5.7 times the $11 million of 2027 adjusted EBITDA that Limbach expects, a 7.9% margin on $140 million of revenue, which is the profile of a project contractor rather than a service business.

Transaction values and multiples are as reported by the linked source or calculated from the figures it gives. Company names are the property of their owners and are shown for identification. Transactions advised by Benchmark International appear on page 15.

Select Recent Industrial Transactions (Continued)

Buyers in power, environmental services, and logistics paid for technicians, permits, equipment supply, and border capability they did not already have.

ANNOUNCED	TARGET AND ACQUIRER	BUSINESS AND TERMS	WHAT IT SHOWS
AUGUST 2026 Building Products & Construction	**CLARK RIGGING & RENTAL** *acquired by* **BAY CRANE**	Bay Crane acquired Clark Rigging & Rental, a crane rental, rigging, and heavy haul company in upstate New York that had been family-owned since 1954 (RER). Terms were not disclosed.	Crane, rigging, and pump rental each have an active acquirer buying family-owned regional operators.
AUGUST 2026 Energy, Power & Environmental	**ENVIROSERVE** *acquired by* **CLEAN HARBORS**	Clean Harbors agreed to buy EnviroServe, a remediation, industrial cleaning, and emergency response company with 40 locations, about $250 million of revenue, and $27 million of adjusted EBITDA, from One Rock Capital Partners for $470 million (Waste Advantage).	Clean Harbors put the price at about nine times adjusted EBITDA after synergies, or about 17 times standalone EBITDA, a month after agreeing to pay 8.7 times post-synergy EBITDA for ES&H (Clean Harbors). A strategic acquirer with a route network pays for density that a sponsor cannot underwrite.
JULY 2026 Energy, Power & Environmental	**CORE TRANSFORMERS** *acquired by* **MISSION CRITICAL GROUP** Emerald Lake Capital Management	Mission Critical Group acquired CORE Transformers, a founder-led supplier of new, made-to-order, and remanufactured power transformers (Distribution Strategy Group). Terms were not disclosed.	It was the buyer's second power equipment purchase in four months, after the Texas switchgear maker TxLa Systems.
OCTOBER 2026 Transportation & Logistics	**RXO** *acquired by* **C.H. ROBINSON**	C.H. Robinson agreed on October 5 to acquire RXO, a truck brokerage, managed transportation, and last-mile provider, at an implied value of $5.8 billion, a 29% premium to RXO's last closing price (C.H. Robinson and RXO).	About $300 million of expected annual cost savings supports the price at the top of the brokerage market.
MARCH 2026 Transportation & Logistics	**EELCO** *acquired by* **REDWOOD LOGISTICS** AEA Investors	Redwood Logistics acquired EELCO, a Laredo, Texas customs brokerage with a foreign-trade-zone warehouse that had been founder-owned since 1991 (FreightWaves). Terms were not disclosed.	Logistics platforms are buying brokers at the border as trade with Mexico sets monthly records.

Transaction values and multiples are as reported by the linked source or calculated from the figures it gives. Company names are the property of their owners and are shown for identification. Two transactions are shown for each of the five industrial sectors across pages 13 and 14.

Benchmark International's Industrial Transactions

Building products and construction services is the most active sector, and strategic acquirers were the buyers in more than half of the sales.

TRAILING 24 MONTHS

85

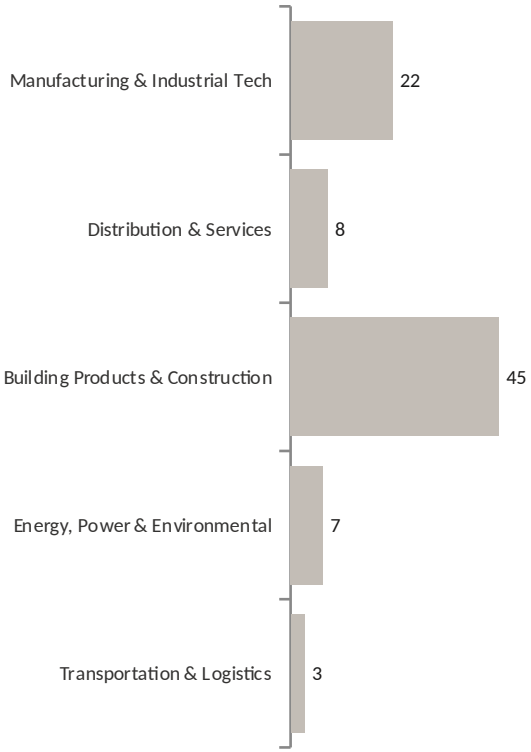
industrial transactions closed in the five sectors

56%

of the 71 companies with a classified buyer were bought by a strategic acquirer

Ranked the leading privately owned sell-side M&A advisor in the world in PitchBook's Q2 2026 Global League Tables (Benchmark International).

BY SECTOR



WHO BOUGHT

Strategic acquirer	**40**	56%
Sponsor-owned platform	**13**	18%
Financial sponsor	**10**	14%
Individual investor	**8**	11%

SELECTED ANNOUNCED ENGAGEMENTS

FPS TECHNOLOGIES INC. HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY CINTAS
Fire suppression and detection systems
DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

MAXVAC HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY DXP
Sales, repair, and maintenance of industrial vacuum pumps
MANUFACTURING

Trinity Industrial Services, LLC HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY AECON
Industrial maintenance, capital projects, and turnarounds
DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY CEMTREX
Instrumentation and wireless sensing for aerospace platforms
MANUFACTURING

Climate Engineering HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY HARRIS
Commercial HVAC and building automation
BUILDING & CONSTRUCTION

BRIGGS HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY PHENNA GROUP
Geotechnical and materials testing and special inspection
BUILDING & CONSTRUCTION

Pelican Packaging HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY TRIUMVIRATE ENVIRONMENTAL
Industrial plastics recycling
ENERGY & ENVIRONMENTAL

WESCO Chemicals, Inc. Water Treatment Sales and Service HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY APEX
Water treatment chemical production and service
ENERGY & ENVIRONMENTAL

DW INDUSTRIES HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY TIPCO TECHNOLOGIES
Hose and hose assemblies for industrial customers
DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

SOLAR ELECTRONICS COMPANY HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY ASSESSIMUS
Test equipment for electromagnetic interference
MANUFACTURING

CLARK CRANE LLC HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY CEX CRANE + LIFT
Crane rental and rigging
BUILDING & CONSTRUCTION

cni HAS BEEN ACQUIRED BY SYMBIA LOGISTICS
Fulfillment and distribution
TRANSPORTATION

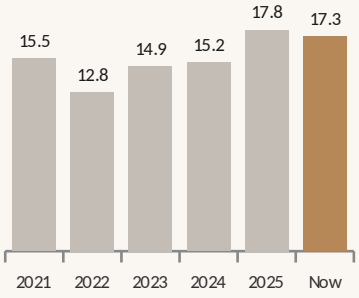
Each tile links to the announcement on benchmarkintl.com. Counts are from Benchmark International's transaction records for the 24 months to September 30, 2026. Fifty-nine of the 85 closed transactions have been announced publicly, and twelve of them are shown here.

Public Company Performance and Trends: Valuation History

Distribution companies trade above any year-end multiple of the past five years; manufacturing and energy have come off their 2025 levels.

Manufacturing & Industrial Tech

17.3x median today

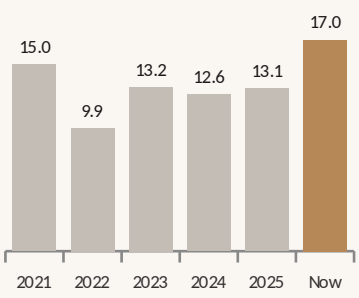


Five-year high	**17.8x**
Five-year low	**12.8x**
Five-year median	**15.2x**
Today against the median	**+2.1x**

8 companies: Parker Hannifin, Rockwell Automation, ITT, Flowserve, Franklin Electric, Graco, Lincoln Electric, Mueller Industries

Distribution & Services

17.0x median today

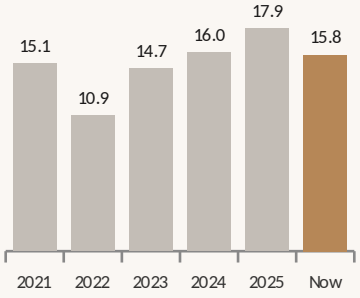


Five-year high	**15.0x**
Five-year low	**9.9x**
Five-year median	**13.1x**
Today against the median	**+3.9x**

8 companies: Fastenal, W.W. Grainger, Applied Industrial Technologies, MSC Industrial Direct, DXP Enterprises, Distribution Solutions, WESCO, Global Industrial

Building Products & Construction

15.8x median today

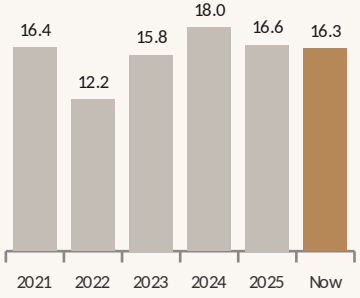


Five-year high	**17.9x**
Five-year low	**10.9x**
Five-year median	**15.1x**
Today against the median	**+0.7x**

9 companies: Comfort Systems USA, EMCOR, IES Holdings, Limbach, Granite Construction, Construction Partners, Builders FirstSource, Watsco, APi Group

Energy, Power & Environmental

16.3x median today

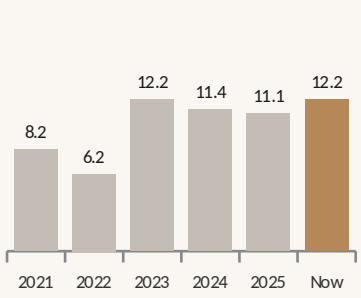


Five-year high	**18.0x**
Five-year low	**12.2x**
Five-year median	**16.4x**
Today against the median	**−0.1x**

8 companies: Generac, Quanta Services, Clean Harbors, Republic Services, Waste Connections, Casella Waste Systems, MYR Group, Primoris Services

Transportation & Logistics

12.2x median today



Five-year high	**12.2x**
Five-year low	**6.2x**
Five-year median	**11.1x**
Today against the median	**+1.1x**

7 companies: J.B. Hunt, Knight-Swift, Werner Enterprises, C.H. Robinson, Landstar System, Schneider National, ArcBest

PRIVATE-MARKET REFERENCE POINTS

Listed multiples describe companies many times larger than a founder-owned business and show relative standing among the sectors.

7.0x

Average for completed middle-market transactions in all industries in the second quarter of 2026 (GF Data via ACG)

5.8x

Median for transactions of $5 million to $50 million in all industries in the second quarter of 2026 (IBBA and M&A Source)

5.0x to 8.0x

Survey medians for manufacturing, wholesale, and construction companies with $1 million to $25 million of EBITDA (Pepperdine)

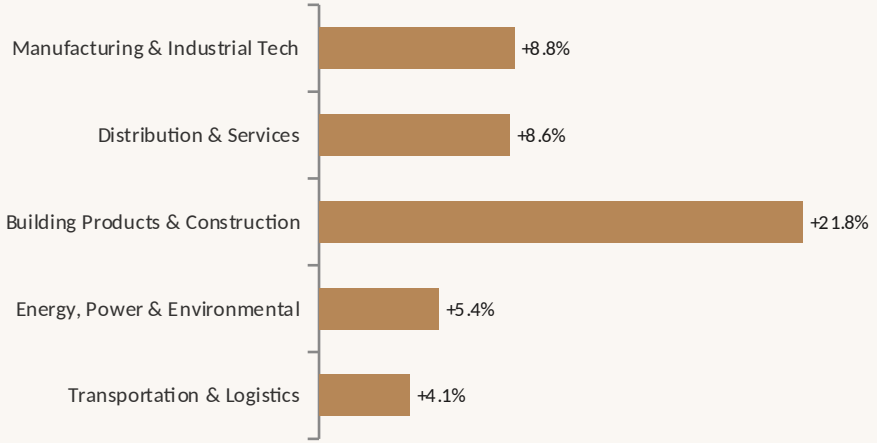
Median enterprise value to trailing EBITDA for 40 listed companies at each company's fiscal year-end from 2021 to 2025 and today; the five-year high, low, and median under each chart use the year-end values. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026, with share prices from October 9 to 19, 2026. Multiples use reported EBITDA, which runs below the adjusted EBITDA companies present. Parker Hannifin, Applied Industrial, and Distribution Solutions show no 2021 multiple and are excluded from that year.

Public Company Performance and Trends: Operating Metrics

Listed contractors grew revenue about 22% while total construction spending fell. Manufacturers reported the highest margins.

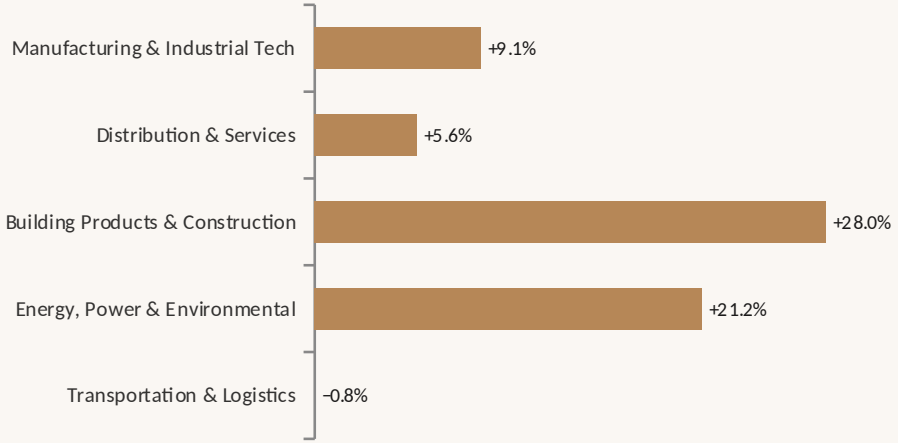
Median revenue growth

Trailing twelve months against the prior twelve, including acquisitions



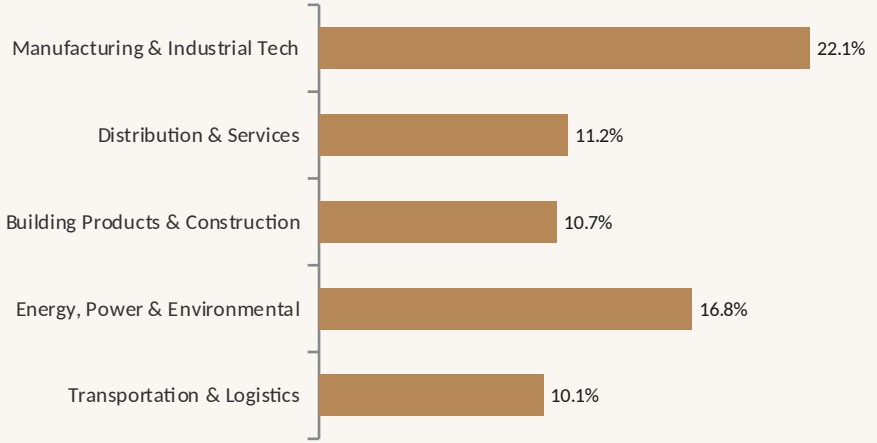
Median EBITDA growth

Latest fiscal year against the prior fiscal year, on reported EBITDA



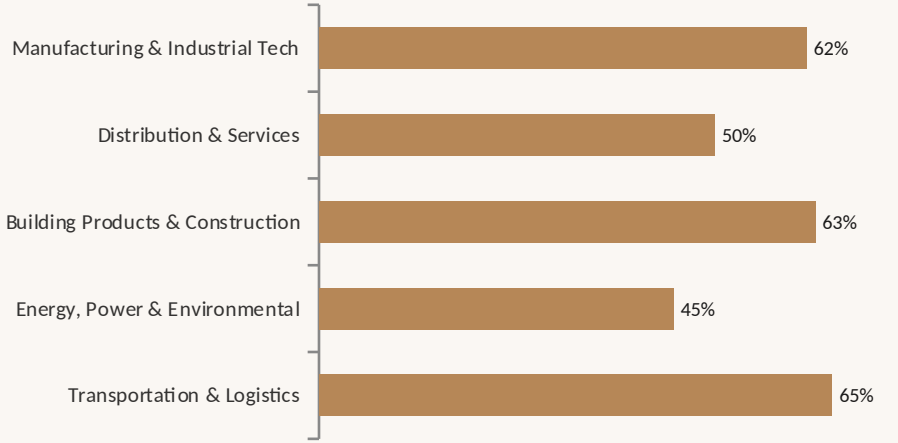
Median EBITDA margin

Trailing twelve months, on reported EBITDA



Median free cash flow conversion

Trailing free cash flow as a share of trailing EBITDA



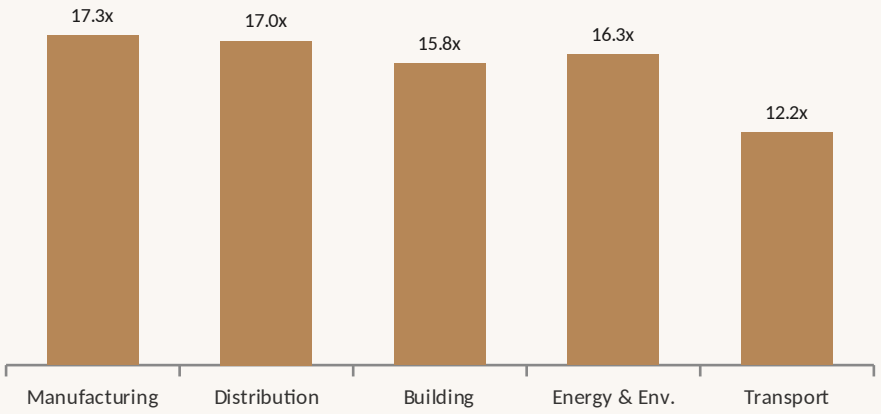
Medians of the 40 listed companies shown on page 16, grouped by sector. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026. Trailing periods end between May and September 2026. EBITDA is as reported and is lower than the adjusted EBITDA that companies present. Forward estimates are not included.

Public Company Performance and Trends: Valuation Metrics

Transportation shares rose a median 39% in a year and still trade at the lowest multiple of EBITDA of the five sectors.

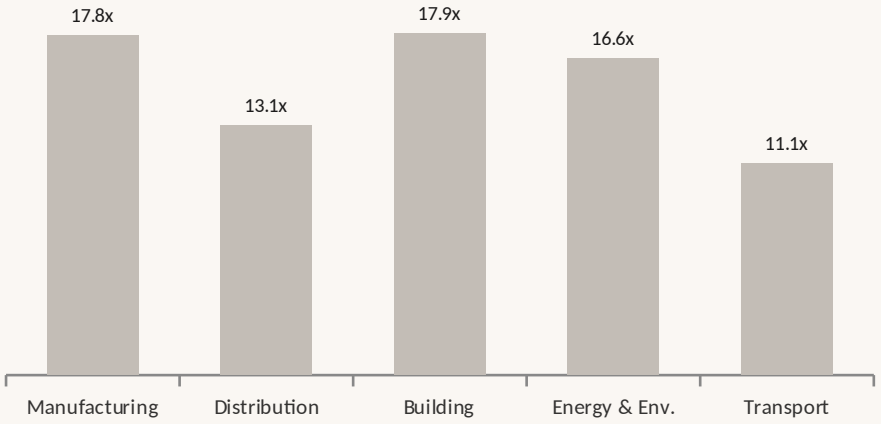
Median enterprise value to trailing EBITDA

Today, on share prices from October 9 to 19, 2026



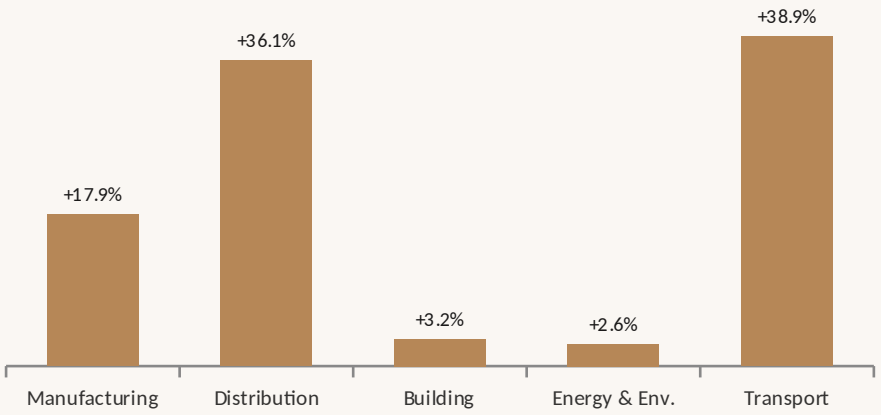
Median enterprise value to EBITDA at fiscal year-end 2025

At each company's 2025 fiscal year-end, for comparison with today



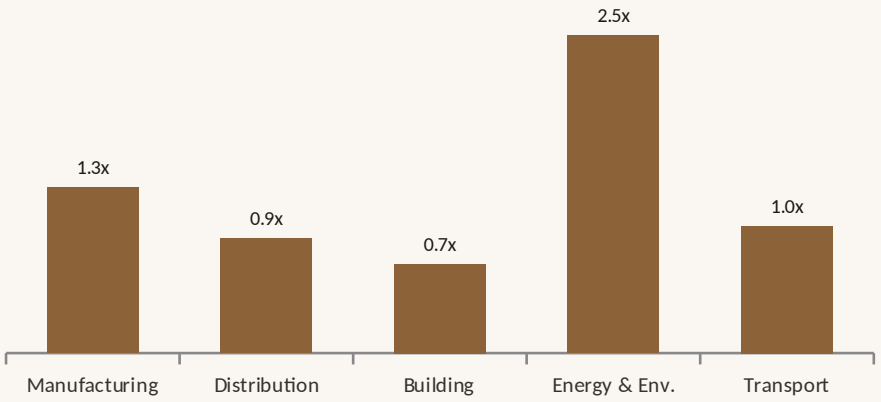
Median change in share price over 52 weeks

Shares rose at 7 of 8 manufacturing, 8 of 8 distribution, 5 of 9 building, 5 of 8 energy, and 7 of 7 transport companies



Median net debt to trailing EBITDA

Total debt less cash, divided by trailing reported EBITDA

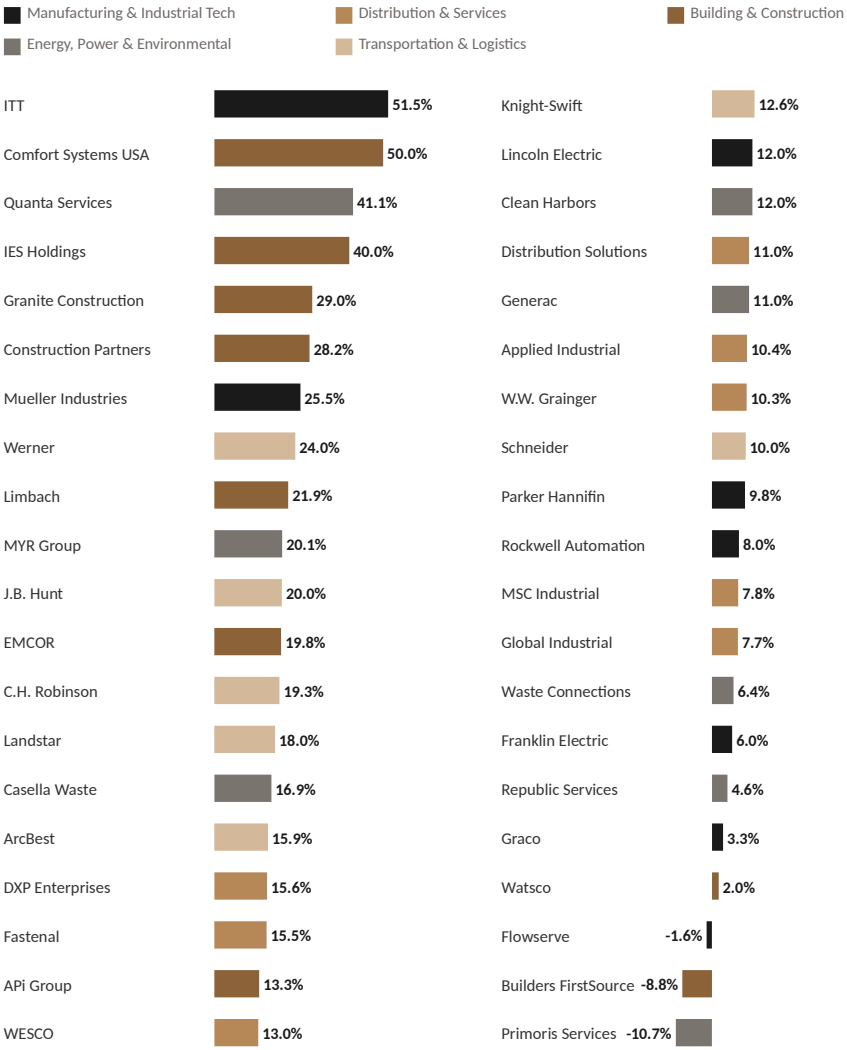


Medians of the 40 listed companies shown on page 16, grouped by sector. Source: StockAnalysis, retrieved October 19, 2026. Year-end 2025 multiples are shown beside today's for comparison. Three of the nine building products and construction companies hold more cash than debt.

Earnings and Commentary

Revenue growth for the 40 listed companies and what management teams said.

YEAR-OVER-YEAR REVENUE GROWTH, LATEST QUARTER



ITT growth is acquisition-driven (organic 12.7%). Werner reflects its second-quarter figure. MSC reports a quarter ended May 30. Primoris has an accounting review noted in its filings.

POWER AND DATA CENTER DEMAND

"We have now posted four consecutive quarters of double-digit sales growth fueled by data centers."
John Engel, WESCO

"Demand across our end markets remains resilient, led by power, nuclear, and energy security investments."
Scott Rowe, Flowserve

WESCO grew sales 13.0%, while Flowserve reported a 1.6% decline in its latest quarter.

BACKLOG AND SERVICES

"Our Remaining Performance Obligations are once again at a record level."
Tony Guzzi, EMCOR

"Within the segment, Technical Services grew revenue 18% on strong demand for disposal and recycling services."
Eric Gerstenberg, Co-CEO, Clean Harbors

EMCOR grew revenue 19.8% and Clean Harbors grew 12%.

DISTRIBUTION AND FREIGHT PRICING

"That said, the demand recovery appears durable and increasingly influenced by structural and secular tailwinds."
Neil Schrimsher, Applied Industrial

"We are seeing the strongest pricing improvement in the parts of our business where the industry is most capacity constrained."
Jim Filter, Schneider

Applied grew revenue 10.4% and Schneider grew 10%.

Economic Trends

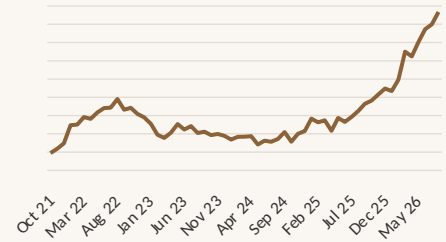
Demand indicators are rising and so are the costs of serving it: steel is up 23%, diesel is up 68%, and the 10-year Treasury averaged 4.99% in September.

Core capital goods orders

Nondefense capital goods excluding aircraft, monthly, US Census Bureau

$87.6B
Aug 2026

+14.1%
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
+14.1%	+17.8%	+21.4%

Source: FRED, series NEWORDER

Manufacturing capacity utilization

Share of manufacturing capacity in use, Federal Reserve

75.9%
Sep 2026

+0.2 pts
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
+0.2 pts	−0.7 pts	−2.1 pts

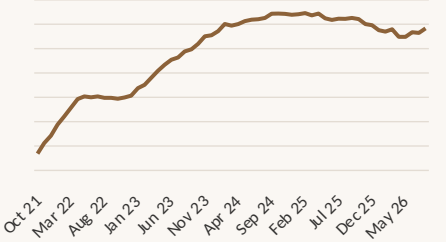
Source: FRED, series MCUMFN

Total construction spending

Seasonally adjusted annual rate, US Census Bureau

$2.20T
Aug 2026

−1.7%
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
−1.7%	+4.5%	+30.5%

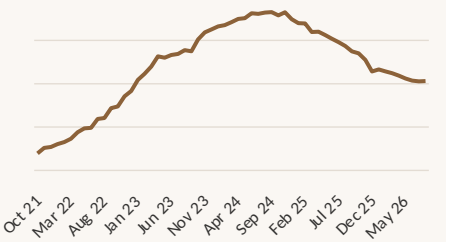
Source: FRED, series TTLCONS

Manufacturing construction

Spending at a seasonally adjusted annual rate, US Census Bureau

$170.7B
Aug 2026

−19.2%
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
−19.2%	−17.3%	+95.7%

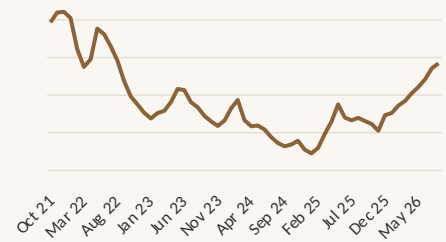
Source: FRED, series TLMFGCONS

Steel mill product prices

Producer price index, 1982 = 100, Bureau of Labor Statistics

381.2
Aug 2026

+23.4%
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
+23.4%	+18.0%	−12.5%

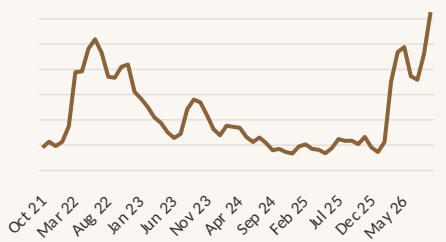
Source: FRED, series WPU1017

Diesel price

US average retail price per gallon, month end, EIA

$6.29
Sep 2026

+67.8%
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
+67.8%	+37.9%	+74.2%

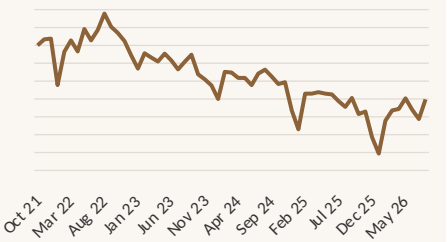
Source: FRED, series GASDESM

Cass Freight Index: shipments

January 1990 = 1.00, Cass Information Systems

1.038
Aug 2026

+2.1%
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
+2.1%	−9.2%	−12.7%

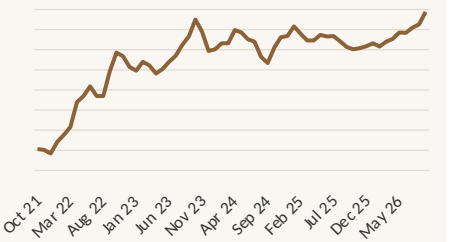
Source: FRED, series FRGSHPUSM649NCIS

10-year Treasury yield

Monthly average of daily yields, Federal Reserve

4.99%
Sep 2026

+0.87 pts
over one year



1 YEAR	3 YEARS	SINCE OCT 2021
+0.87 pts	+0.61 pts	+3.4 pts

Source: FRED, series GS10

Each series runs monthly from October 2021 to its latest reading, which is August 2026 for all series except capacity utilization (September 2026, from the G.17 release of October 16), diesel, and the Treasury yield (September 2026). Recent months are preliminary and subject to revision.

Select Market Participants

Public reference companies, active buyers, and sponsors with relevant sector investment experience.

MANUFACTURING & INDUSTRIAL TECH

LISTED COMPANIES

Parker, Rockwell Automation, ITT, Flowserve, Franklin Electric, Graco, Lincoln Electric, Mueller Industries

ACTIVE BUYERS

nVent, Franklin Electric, Precinmac, DXP, Cemtrex, Assessimus

SPONSORS

Centerbridge, CORE Industrial, Wynnchurch, AIP

DISTRIBUTION & SERVICES

LISTED COMPANIES

Fastenal, Grainger, Applied Industrial Technologies, MSC, DXP, DSG Distribution Solutions Group, Wesco, Global Industrial

ACTIVE BUYERS

Ferguson, Meritus, Cintas, TIPCO Technologies, Aecon

SPONSORS

AEA Investors, Audax PE, Gryphon, Wynnchurch

BUILDING & CONSTRUCTION

LISTED COMPANIES

Comfort Systems USA, EMCOR, IES, Limbach, Granite, Construction Partners Inc., Builders FirstSource, Watsco, API Group

ACTIVE BUYERS

Limbach, Bay Crane, Harris, Phenna Group, PB Pye-Barker, CEX Crane + Lift

SPONSORS

Huron Capital, Gryphon, Altas Partners, Leonard Green

ENERGY, POWER & ENVIRONMENTAL

LISTED COMPANIES

Generac, Quanta, Clean Harbors, Republic Services, Waste Connections, Casella, MYR Group, Primoris

ACTIVE BUYERS

Clean Harbors, Mission Critical Group, Triumvirate Environmental, Apex

SPONSORS

Emerald Lake, One Rock, Bernhard, Gryphon

TRANSPORTATION & LOGISTICS

LISTED COMPANIES

J.B. Hunt, Werner, C.H. Robinson, Landstar, Schneider, ArcBest, Knight Transportation, Knight-Swift

ACTIVE BUYERS

C.H. Robinson, Redwood, Imperative Logistics, Symbia Logistics

SPONSORS

AEA Investors, H.I.G. Capital, Greenbriar, Audax PE

03

About Benchmark

Benchmark International's Middle Market team represents owners of privately held companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value in strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions. The first step is a confidential conversation about your goals, your company, and your options, with no pressure and no commitments.

23 About Benchmark International

24 Connect with our team

25 Sources



Benchmark International

The world's leading privately owned sell-side M&A advisor focused on five industries.

BENCHMARK® INTERNATIONAL

Benchmark International advises owners of privately held companies around the world, and its Middle Market team represents owners of companies with $50 million to $500 million of total enterprise value in strategic sales, mergers, and qualifying change-of-control transactions. The first step is a confidential conversation about your goals, your company, and your options.

#1

Privately owned sell-side M&A advisor worldwide, based on PitchBook's Q2 2026 Global League Tables

$50M to $500M

Total enterprise value range the Middle Market team serves

5

Focused industry groups with dedicated sector expertise

15

Global offices across the Americas, Europe, and Africa

RECOGNITION

THE M&A ADVISOR
INVESTMENT BANKING FIRM OF THE YEAR

PitchBook
#1 SELL-SIDE EXCLUSIVE M&A ADVISOR IN THE WORLD

LSEG
#1 PRIVATELY-HELD M&A ADVISORS WORLDWIDE

DealMakers
MERGERS & ACQUISITIONS (UNLISTED DEALS) FIRST IN THE CATEGORY OF INVESTMENT ADVISERS (DEAL FLOW)

FIVE INDUSTRY GROUPS

- INDUSTRIALS
- BUSINESS SERVICES
- CONSUMER
- HEALTHCARE
- TECHNOLOGY

Ranking based on PitchBook's Q2 2026 Global League Tables, as published at benchmarkintl.com. Awards as shown on the Benchmark International Middle Market site.

Connect With Us

A first conversation is confidential and carries no obligation.

CONFIDENTIAL. NO PRESSURE. NO COMMITMENTS.

It all starts with a conversation.

Want to explore your options or know more? Our first step is always a confidential conversation exploring your goals, your company, and your options. Owners considering a strategic sale, merger, or qualifying change-of-control transaction in the five industrial sectors, and the advisors who work with them, are welcome to call or email.



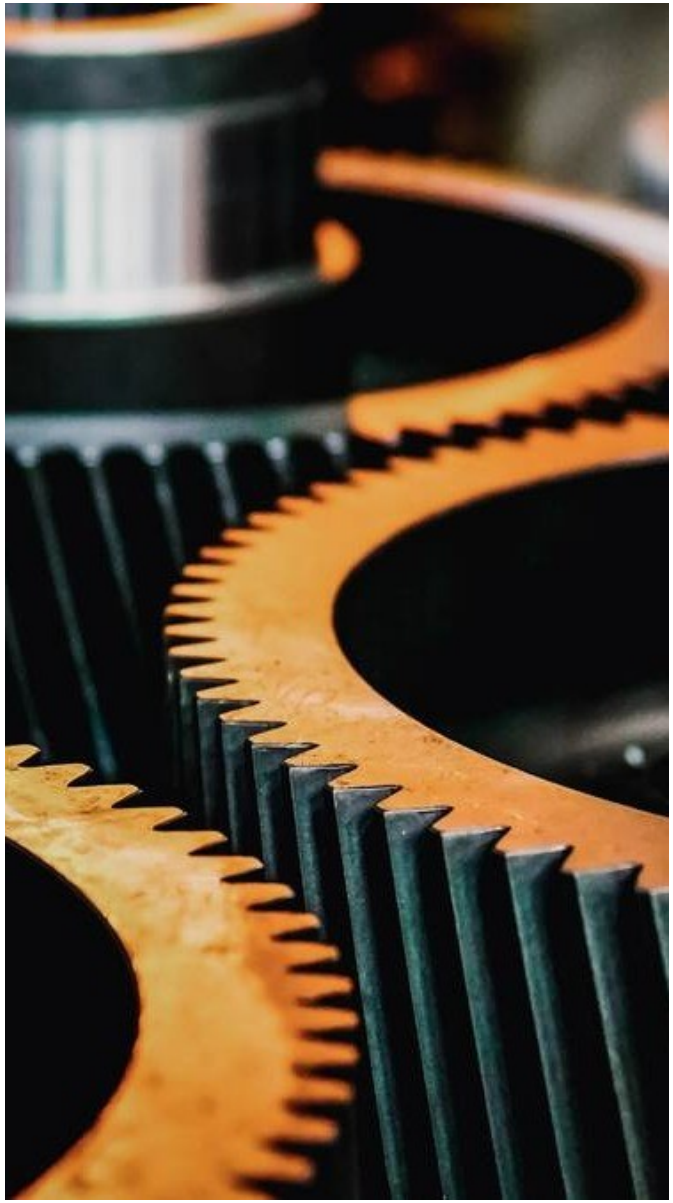
Jared Hardin

MANAGING DIRECTOR

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SCHEDULE A CONVERSATION



Sources

Sources cited in this report, collected by section. Links in the slides open the page each figure came from.

INSIGHTS (PAGES 5 TO 11)

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Generac sec.gov
nVent globenewswire.com
EMCOR sec.gov
ABC globenewswire.com
Limbach businesswire.com
Dallas Innovates dallasinnovates.com
Distribution Strategy Group distributionstrategy.com
ABC, reported by Construction Dive constructiondive.com
Vertikal vertikal.net
Census data reported by FreightWaves freightwaves.com
FreightWaves on EELCO freightwaves.com
FreightWaves on Jose D. Gonzalez, CHB freightwaves.com
Lincoln International lincolninternational.com
Bg2 Pod bg2pod.com
CNBC cnbc.com
EQT Corporation youtube.com/@EQTCorp
Quanta Services quantaservices.com

TRANSACTIONS (PAGES 13 AND 14)

Franklin Electric and Cat Pumps: Franklin Electric franklin-electric.com
Precinmac and Advance Mfg. Co.: Precinmac prnewswire.com
Ferguson and FloWorks: MDM mdm.com
Meritus Gas Partners and Metroplex Welding Supply: MDM mdm.com
Limbach Holdings and 1901 Inc.: Pulse 2.0 pulse2.com
Bay Crane and Clark Rigging & Rental: RER rermag.com
Clean Harbors and EnviroServe: Waste Advantage wasteadvantagemag.com
Clean Harbors and EnviroServe: Clean Harbors sec.gov
C.H. Robinson and RXO sec.gov

BENCHMARK INTERNATIONAL (PAGES 6, 9, 10, 11, 15 AND 21)

The Carmi Companies and The Nearshore Company benchmarkintl.com
FPS Technologies, Inc. and Cintas Corporation benchmarkintl.com
MaxVac Inc. and DXP Enterprises, Inc. benchmarkintl.com
Trinity Industrial Services, LLC and Aecon Group Inc. benchmarkintl.com
Invocon, Inc. and Cemtrex, Inc. benchmarkintl.com
Climate Engineering, Inc. and Harris Company benchmarkintl.com
Briggs Engineering & Testing and Phenna Group benchmarkintl.com
Capitol Plastics Recycling Inc. and Triumvirate Environmental benchmarkintl.com
WESCO Chemicals, Inc. and Apex Water and Process Inc. benchmarkintl.com
DW Industries and TIPCO Technologies benchmarkintl.com
A.T. Parker, Inc. (Solar Electronics) and Assessimus Group GmbH benchmarkintl.com
Clark Crane, LLC and Capital Extension Crane & Lift benchmarkintl.com
Christian Network International and Symbia Logistics benchmarkintl.com
Benchmark International benchmarkintl.com

PUBLIC COMPANIES AND ECONOMIC TRENDS (PAGES 16 TO 21)

IBBA and M&A Source ibba.org
Pepperdine digitalcommons.pepperdine.edu
StockAnalysis stockanalysis.com
FRED: Core capital goods orders (NEWORDER) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Manufacturing capacity utilization (MCUMFN) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Total construction spending (TTLCONS) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Manufacturing construction (TLMFGCONS) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Steel mill product prices (WPU1017) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Diesel price (GASDESM) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: Cass Freight Index: shipments (FRGSHPUSM649NCIS) fred.stlouisfed.org
FRED: 10-year Treasury yield (GS10) fred.stlouisfed.org
Company earnings releases and calls investor relations sites

SPONSORS AND LOGOS (PAGES 13 TO 15 AND 21)

Centerbridge Partners
Wynnchurch Capital
AEA Investors
Gryphon Investors
Altas Partners
Emerald Lake Capital
Bernhard Capital Partners
Greenbriar Equity Group
CORE Industrial Partners
American Industrial Partners
Audax Private Equity
Huron Capital
Leonard Green & Partners
One Rock Capital Partners
H.I.G. Capital

Listed-company figures are from StockAnalysis and use reported EBITDA. Economic series are from FRED and the Federal Reserve G.17 release. Benchmark International figures are from the firm's transaction records as of October 1, 2026. Private transaction values and multiples are as reported by the acquirer or calculated from the figures it disclosed.

Logos: company websites and issuer media assets. Sponsor names link to portfolio or investment evidence.